

The costs of obesity in the workplace.

OBJECTIVE: To quantify per capita and aggregate medical expenditures and the value of lost productivity, including absenteeism and presenteeism, because of overweight, and grade I, II, and III obesity among U.S. employees. **METHODS:** Cross-sectional analysis of the 2006 Medical Expenditure Panel Survey and the 2008 National Health and Wellness Survey. **RESULTS:** Among men, estimates range from -\$322 for overweight to \$6087 for grade III obese men. For women, estimates range from \$797 for overweight to \$6694 for grade III. In aggregate, the annual cost attributable to obesity among full-time employees is \$73.1 billion. Individuals with a body mass index >35 represent 37% of the obese population but are responsible for 61% of excess costs. **CONCLUSIONS:** Successful efforts to reduce the prevalence of obesity, especially among those with a body mass index >35, could result in significant savings to employers.